

Past Grant Application 2: Birthing On Country Partnership

1. Application Overview

- **Applicant:** Urapuntja Health Service Aboriginal Corporation (UHSAC)
 - **Partner:** Southern Cross University (SCU) (Administering Institution)
 - **ABN:** 45 449 518 275 (UHSAC)
 - **Funder:** Commonwealth Department of Health and Aged Care (DoHAC)
 - **Funding Program:** Medical Research Future Fund (MRFF) / Indigenous Health Research Program
 - **Amount Allocated (UHSAC Portion):** \$350,000.00 (Total project value: \$1.2M)
 - **Status:** Successfully Awarded (Agreement executed Sep 2023)
 - **Completion Date:** 30 June 2026
 - **Key Contact:** James Stacey (former CEO) / Ms. Melissa Hinson (current CEO)
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2. Project Proposal

2.1 Project Title

Building capacity of regional and remote ACCHOs for Birthing on Country Initiatives and augmented smoking cessation care through University-ACCHO partnerships

2.2 Project Summary

UHSAC in partnership with Southern Cross University proposes a collaborative action research model to design and implement a culturally integrated "Birthing on Country" model in the Utopia Homelands. The program aims to establish maternal health services that respect traditional lore and practice, while integrating clinical midwifery care. Additionally, the project will embed augmented smoking cessation programs tailored specifically for expectant First Nations mothers in remote regions, aiming to reduce low birthweight and premature births.

2.3 Objectives

1. Recruit and train 2.0 FTE local Aboriginal Health Practitioners (AHPs) in maternal health support.
2. Establish a co-designed, culturally appropriate antenatal clinic facility at Soapy Bore.
3. Reduce smoking rates among pregnant Alyawarr and Anmatyerr women by 30% over three years.
4. Establish formal clinical escalation pathways with Alice Springs Hospital for high-risk pregnancies.

2.4 Project Deliverables

- Co-designed antenatal care guidelines combining clinical midwifery and traditional doula/grandmother support.
- Local training program for maternal health workers.
- Culturally safe education brochures and carbon monoxide monitoring units.

3. Project Budget (UHSAC Share)

Expense Category	Description	Year 1 (AUD)	Year 2 (AUD)	Year 3 (AUD)
Personnel	1.0 FTE Maternal Health Coordinator + 1.0 FTE local trainee	\$110,000	\$115,000	\$120,000
Travel & Outreach	Off-road travel to outstations for antenatal testing	\$15,000	\$15,000	\$15,000
Equipment	Portable fetal monitors, ultrasound units, CO monitors	\$25,000	\$5,000	\$5,000
Community Consultation	Homeland elder workshops, focus groups, translation	\$10,000	\$10,000	\$10,000
Total Annual Costs		\$160,000	\$145,000	\$150,000
Total Grant Allocation	\$350,000 (after SCU administration & indirect costs)			